

TOP DENTISTS
2024



CHILLING MEMORIES OF A
1974 PLANE CRASH



MEET ARLINGTON'S
STAR SWIMMER



WHERE TO EAT AT
DCA AND IAD

Northern Virginia

NOVEMBER 2024

50 BEST

RESTAURANTS

OUR CRITICS' PICKS FOR TOP-NOTCH NOVA DINING



NOVEMBER 2024

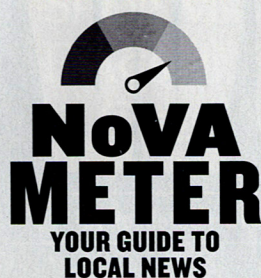
\$4.95

1 1 >



0 74470 27073 7

THE SPECTRUM



Falls Church is the healthiest U.S. community, according to *U.S. News & World Report*.

Virginia ranks ninth for the best public education, based on K-12 performance, funding, higher ed, and safety, according to ConsumerAffairs.

The commonwealth ranks 16th in a national survey of what states are the happiest, WalletHub finds. Maryland comes in second.

Great Falls is No. 9 on GoBankingRates' list of cities with the richest middle class. The minimum middle-class income there is \$249,157. The maximum: \$747,470.

Prince William County has NoVA's highest rate of food insecurity at 43 percent, according to the Capital Area Food Bank.



A New Perspective

Alexandria's presumptive mayor talks about challenges, growth, and diversity.

By Colleen Kelleher



ALVIA GASKINS ADMITS she's a "big policy nerd," and as the only candidate on the ballot for Alexandria mayor, she plans to take full advantage of her background in public health and urban planning once in office.

ON OUR RADAR

By Maggie Roth



ALBUM

Coyote by Tommy Richman

Following the success of single "Million Dollar Baby," this Woodbridge rapper released his first full album this fall, with tunes like "Thought You Were the One."

BOOK

Wind Is a Dance by Debra Kempf Shumaker

A NoVA author uses whimsical language and metaphors to teach young readers about the different types of wind.





Gaskins supports mentoring programs like Cornerstone Craftsman that give at-risk youth the opportunity to earn a livable wage and viable careers in skilled trades.

The first-term Alexandria City Council member has been meeting with staffers, residents, and business owners and diving deeper into the minutia of city issues since she won the June Democratic primary.

"I want to make sure that those nuances are almost like second nature by the time I'm prepared to take office," Gaskins says.

Immediate issues she wants to tackle include expanding Alexandria's tax base, housing affordability, child care costs and availability, youth mental health issues, and ensuring young people have pathways to employment after they graduate.

The city needs to be intentional about growing its commercial tax base, she says. "The reality is there are lots of needs and challenges we have, and we have to be able to pay for them. And our current dependence on residential homeowners, it's unsustainable," Gaskins says, adding she views projects in the city as a connected puzzle with each one impacting another. "What is our vision for commercial growth? What is our vision for economic development across the city? And what's our strategy for getting there?"

In the West End, where she lives and where Inova is building a new Alexandria hospital, Gaskins foresees redevelopment. "I think what you're going to see there is more housing, more hotels, more restaurants, which will be a great thing for that part of the area," she says. "I would love there to also be like an arts and cultural hub, or some sort of space that is a celebration of the arts and the diversity on the West End."

Gaskins says she believes Alexandria's diversity is one of its greatest strengths and wants to make sure city services are designed with residents and small-business owners in mind.

And she is not taking lightly the historic nature of becoming, at the age of 35, the first Black woman mayor in the city's 275-year history. "The historic nature of the election is also sitting with me in both a place of great humility that I have the opportunity to lead our city at this time, but also a recognition of what that means for other little girls who look like me, and the opportunity I have to not just be a leader but an example and hopefully a mentor and an inspiration to other girls who think they can make change in their community."

BOOK

***Bye Forever, I Guess* by Jodi Meadows**

This new middle-grade, coming-of-age book from the Shenandoah Valley author known for *My Lady Jane* explores themes of love and friendship in a digital age.



BOOK

***Private Violence: Latin American Women and the Struggle for Asylum* by Carol Cleaveland and Michele Waslin**

A GMU professor examines how immigration laws impact Latin American women seeking asylum for claims of gender-based violence.

MOVIE

HITPIG!

You'll recognize the voice of Fairfax native Jason Sudeikis in this animated film about a pig that catches escaped animals and returns them to their owners. In theaters November 1.

